

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠	-	♠	-
♥	-	♥	-
♦	-	♦	-
♣	-	♣	-

♠ A 8 7
♥ K Q 8 7 3
♦ J
♣ A 9 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 5 2
♥ 2
♦ A Q T 9 8 7 5
♣ 8 7

West

North

East

South

All Pass
3♦ by South

3♦

Baker Preempt 1

[show S]

You dealt this hand. Decide what you would bid, then click on BID above. [BID 3♦]

[show NS]

You estimate you can win 6 ♦ tricks so you open 3♦. Everybody passes.

Board 2

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ K Q J T 8 6 4

♥ 9 7

♦ 6 5

♣ T 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 2

♥ K J 8 5

♦ K J 9

♣ K Q 8 3

West

North

East

South

3♠

All Pass

3♠ by North

Q J 10 x x x of trumps and nothing in any other suit. Then base your decision on that.

Baker Preempt 2

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. Decide what you would bid, then click on BID above. [BID pass]

[show NS]

You have 13 points and if partner had opened with a 1♠ bid you'd be feeling "jumpy". But what a preemptive bidder needs from dummy are immediate winners, not points. So you pass.

Here's a pretty good tip: When partner opens with a 3-bid and you are trying to decide whether to take him to game, visualize him holding this very hand: K

Board 3
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ J 9 8 7 3

♥ A 4 2

♦ 8 2

♣ A K 7

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ A

♥ Q J T 8 7 6 3

♦ 9 7 5

♣ 6 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	4♥		3♥
All Pass 4♥ by South			

Baker Preempt 3
[show S]

You dealt this hand. Decide what you would bid, then click on BID above. [BID 3♥]

You expect your hand to produce 5♥ tricks and the ♠A. So you open 3♥. Partner responds 4♥. What do you bid? [BID pass]

[show NS]

When you preempted 3♥ you described your hand perfectly. You have nothing more to say except pass.

Board 4

North Deals

None Vul

♠	-		♠	-
♥	-		♥	-
♦	-		♦	-
♣	-		♣	-

♠ 8 3
 ♥ K Q T 8 7 4 2
 ♦ 8 6 2
 ♣ 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 7 6
 ♥ J 5 3
 ♦ 9 4
 ♣ A 8 7 4

West

North

East

South

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass
 4♥ by North

happily ever after.

Baker Preempt 4

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. Decide what you would bid, then click on BID above. [BID 4♥]

[show NS]

No matter how much we try to reduce bridge to rules and guidelines we will never get rid of the judgement factor. With this hand you definitely have 3 fast tricks for partner. In theory he can take 6 of his own, so 3♥ should be the right contract. BUT, maybe he could ruff a ♦ in your dummy?

Fortune favors the bold so you bid 4♥ . . . and live

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ -	♠ T 4	♠ -									
♥ -	♥ Q 8 6	♥ -									
♦ -	♦ A 9 6 3	♦ -									
♣ -	♣ J 6 4 2	♣ -									
	<table><tr><td></td><td>N</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>W</td><td></td><td>E</td></tr><tr><td></td><td>S</td><td></td></tr></table>		N		W		E		S		
	N										
W		E									
	S										
	♠ K Q J 9 8 7 5 2										
	♥ 9										
	♦ 5 2										
	♣ 8 7										

West

North

East

South

All Pass

4♠ by South

lower your preempt, the less difficult it is for the opponent's to enter the bidding. If you had opened 3♠ West might have been able to make a Takeout Double and they could have found their ♥ fit. Just visualize their combined hands; they have 9 ♥s between them, they have no ♠ losers, no ♣ losers and just one ♦ loser. If they decide to finesse your partner for the ♥Q they can make slam.

This is what preempting is all about.

Baker Preempt 5

[show S]

You dealt this hand. Decide what you would bid, then click on BID above. [BID 4♠]

[show NS]

With 7 estimated winners and an 8-card suit you preempt 4♠. And you are not going to make it. In fact you are only going to make 8 tricks so you will go down 2.

You may be wishing that you had opened just 3♠, rather than following the guidelines and opening at the 4-level. The problem with that thinking is that the

Board 6

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ K Q J 9 8 7 3

♥ 6

♦ 9 8 4 2

♣ 7

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ T 6

♥ A K Q 8 5

♦ A K

♣ A 8 6 4

West

North

East

South

3♠

Pass

6♠

All Pass

6♠ by North

would have led a ♣.

Baker Preempt 6

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. Decide what you would bid, then click on BID above. [BID 6♠]

[show NS]

If is hard to imagine any hand partner could have where the slam wouldn't be there. Maybe you should use Blackwood, just to be sure? If partner shows 1 Ace you would then bid 6♠. And if he shows no Aces you would then . . . bid 6♠ anyway. So you leave out the middle step and bid 6♠.

Did you think about bidding 6NT instead? Ugh, they

Board 7
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ Q 8 7 6

♥ 5

♦ A J T 4

♣ J 8 5 3

♠ 9 5

♥ K Q T 8 7 6 3

♦ 8 2

♣ T 9

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

West	North	East	South
			3♥
Dbl	Pass	3♠	
All Pass 3♠ by East			
hand partner will have to do it.			

Baker Preempt 7
[show S]

You dealt this hand. Decide what you would bid, then click on BID above. [BID 3♥]

You make a simple 3♥ opening bid and then the fireworks start. West doubles, your partner passes and East bids 3♠. What do you bid now? [BID pass]

[show NS]

Do not preempt the same hand twice. The idea of a preemptive bid is that you bid it's maximum at your first turn. If there is to any further competing on this

Board 8

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ 4
 ♥ 6 5 2
 ♦ K Q J T 8 7 3
 ♣ 8 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 6 3 2
 ♥ K 8
 ♦ A 9 6 4
 ♣ A 7 3

West	North	East	South
	3♦	3♠	4♦

All Pass
 4♦ by North

Baker Preempt 8

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. Decide what you would bid, then click on BID above. [BID 4♦]

[show NS]

You do not have the 4 fast winners you need to raise partner to the 4-level. But you do have 4 of his trumps and 2 and a half winners. And your side doesn't have much defense against a 3♠ contract. You should raise partner to 4♦ because you think they can make 3♠. With these hands it appears they might have gone to 4♠ in which case you would have had to decide whether to continue to 5♦. More

judgement would be called for, based on Vulnerability, whether you think they can make the game, etc. The Law of Total Tricks can be a help in these competitive situations; it would lead you to 5♦.

Board 9

South Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ A 8
 ♥ 8 7 4
 ♦ J 9 4 2
 ♣ K 6 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 5
 ♥ 6
 ♦ A Q T 8 7 6 3
 ♣ T 9 5

West	North	East	South
			3♦
Dbl	4♦	4♥	
All Pass			
4♥ by East			

Baker Preempt 9

[show S]

You dealt this hand. Decide what you would bid, then click on BID above. [BID 3♦]

You open 3♦. West doubles, partner raises to 4♦, and East bids 4♥. What do you say? [BID pass]

[show NS]

You just pass. Partner's raise was probably just advancing your preempt and they got to 4♥ anyway. Sometimes preempts don't do the full job.

It is partner's decision, not yours, whether to continue to 5♦ as a sacrifice.

Board 10

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ 8 5 3
♥ A Q J 9 8 4 3
♦ T 7 6
♣ -

	N	
W	S	E

♠ 9 6 4
♥ -
♦ 8 5 4 2
♣ A K Q J 8 3

West

North
3♥

East

South

All Pass
3♥ by North

a guideline that says:

Baker Preempt 10

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. Decide what you would bid, then click on BID above. [BID pass]

[show NS]

The guidelines in the summary would have you bid 4♥. After all you very clearly have four quick winners.

But you also have seven quick losers in the other suits, and a trump void to boot.

Somewhere in some of these lessons there should be

Board 11

East Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ Q 5
♥ A J 8 3
♦ Q 7 6 5
♣ K Q 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K T 8 7 6 3
♥ 6
♦ 8 4
♣ T 9 5

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

3 ♠

All Pass
3 ♠ by South

Baker Preempt 11

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. Decide what you would bid, then click on BID above. [BID 3 ♠]

[show NS]

The fact that East opened doesn't change your hand at all. You had planned on Opening 3 ♠, now you make a Weak Jump Overcall of 3 ♠. If partner has some "stuff" you might get to a makeable contract, and if he doesn't you may keep the opponents out of a ♥ game.

This time everybody passes.

Board 12

West Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ Q
♥ K J T 9 6 4 2
♦ T 8
♣ 7 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 7 2
♥ Q 7
♦ A 5 4 2
♣ A 9 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	3 ♥	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass 4 ♥ by North			

Baker Preempt 12

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. Decide what you would bid, then click on BID above. [BID 4 ♥]

[show NS]

You have four quick winners. If partner had opened 3 ♥ you would have bid 4 ♥ in the blink of an eye. His Weak Jump Overcall describes the exact same hand. So blink and bid 4 ♥.